

Problem 1. Sudanese Arabic

Solution:

Regularity of meaning is reflected in regularity of form i.e. same word form is used to denote same chunk of meaning. For e.g. in the example given below, in column A, the common segment is 'sirib', while in column B, the common part is 'drank'. Therefore, it can be said that 'sirib' roughly corresponds to 'drank'. In the similar manner, 'hamal' (in column C) can be said to roughly correspond to 'carried' (in column D). On the other hand, the segments occurring repeatedly in row E are 'ta' and 'I (subject)'. Therefore, it can be said that 'ta' roughly corresponds to 'I (subject)'. Similarly, 'tu' seems to roughly correspond to 'you pl. (subject)'.

	A	B	C	D
E	siribta	I drank.	hamalta	I carried.
F	siribtu	You pl. drank.	hamaltu	You pl. carried.

When this reasoning is applied to rest of the data, we find following markers and their corresponding meaning-

Marker	Meaning
---0	Subject- 3 rd sg. Masc.
---ta	Subject- 1 st sg.
---ti	Subject- 2 nd sg. Fem.
-tu	Subject- 2 nd pl.
---na	Subject- 1 st pl.
---at	Subject- 3 rd sg. Fem.
---u	Subject- 3 rd pl.
---ina	Object- 1 st pl.
---ihum	Object- 3 rd pl.
---i	Object- 3 rd sg. Masc.
---iha	Object- 3 rd sg. Fem.

Set A

Past forms of the verb stems- 'sirib' and 'hamal'

3rdsg. Mas- [0]

1stsg.- [ta]

2ndsg. Fem. – [ti]

2nd pl. – [tu]

1st pl. – [na]

Set B

3rdsg. Fem- [at] within stem, dropping
of [i] 3rd pl. – [u] within stem,
dropping of [i]

Set C

No object- [0]
1st pl. object-
[ina] 3rd pl.
object- [ihum]
3rdsg.Mas.
Object- [i]
3rdsg. Fem. Object- [iha]

Order of attachment

Verb stem + subject marker + object
marker We carried him- hamalnai
You pl. carried her- hamaltuihas
